

Year 7 Saudi History Book 1

Term 3 Contents

Arabic Language

The language of Saudi Arabia is Arabic. It is very different from English and even has a different alphabet and is written in a different way. In English, we write from left to right, but in Arabic we write from right to left.

Arabic is one of the most important languages in the world. Why not, as it is the language of the Holy Qur'an.

Millions of Muslims in the world speak Arabic. They read the Holy Qur'an and perform their prayers. They also use Arabic to deal with people when they arrive at Makkah.

Arabic is not only spoken by the Arabs. Many Europeans now learn Arabic. They use it to read the books of famous Arab scientists. They also use it in business and trade. Arabic is now one of the languages of the United Nations.

In a word, Arabic still has its special importance among all other languages.

Simple Arabic Phrases (1)

There are several different ways to greet people. We will learn three different greetings now. When we want to say 'welcome' to somebody we say, «Ahallan wa sahlana».

Another way to greet someone is, «As salaam 'aalaykum».

The third greeting we will learn is «Hello». In Arabic this is translated to, «Marhaba».

Another useful phrase to learn is to say «Goodbye» to somebody and this is translated to, «Ma' Assalama».

If we want to say «Thank you» to somebody we say, «Shukran».

Simple Arabic Phrases (2)

We are now going to learn some useful words that we can use in everyday speech. The word «boy» is 'WALAD'. The word for «girl» is 'BINT'. If you have a friend in the class then you have a «SADEEQ». This is Arabic for friend.

The man who stands at the blackboard at the front of the class is «MOUALIM». This is the Arabic for a male teacher.

The lady who stands at the blackboard in your class is «MOUALIMAH». This is the Arabic for a female teacher.

Finally, the place in which you learn lessons is «MADRASAH». This is the Arabic for school.

Arabic Numbers

Arabic Numbers Lesson– Arabic Numbers

We will now learn some Arabic numbers. These numbers are useful to learn and easy to remember.

Digit Arabic Symbol Transliteration

0	٠	sifr
1	١	waahid
2	٢	eethnayn
3	٣	thalaatha
4	٤	arba'a
5	٥	khamisa
6	٦	sitta
7	٧	sab'a
8	٨	thamaaneeya
9	٩	tis'a

Arabic numerals are the ten digits (0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9), which—along with the system by which a sequence (e.g., «406») was read as a number.

The term **Arabic numerals** may also refer to the closely related **Eastern Arabic numerals** (٠١٢٣٤٥٦٧٨٩), which are more closely associated with Arabic speakers than the Western Arabic numerals.

Arabic numerals are the conventional name for the family of numerals invented by **Indian mathematicians around 500 AD**, which are related to or ancestral to Western numerals. This invention, which involved zero and a decimal positional notation, is considered an important milestone in mathematics.

The reason that (0,1,2,3,4,5,6,7,8,9) are known as **Arabic numerals**, despite their Indian heritage, was that it was the Arabs who adopted the system from India in the 9th century and introduced it to Europe in the 10th. Europeans therefore wrongly attributed the numerals to the Arabs, even though the Arabs themselves called them **“Hindu numerals.”**

Location

The kingdom occupies eighty percent of the Arabian Peninsula.

The size of the country is estimated at **2 million square kilometers**. It is roughly **one-third the size of the continental United States**, and the same size as all of Western Europe.

Saudi Arabia lies at the crossroads of three continents: Europe, Asia, and Africa.

It extends from the **Red Sea** on the west to the **Arabian Gulf** in the east. To the north, it borders on **Jordan, Iraq, and Kuwait**, and to the south, on **Yemen and the Sultanate of Oman**.

To the east lie the **United Arab Emirates, Qatar, and the Kingdom of Bahrain**.

Climate

The climate is dry and hot. Dry desert with great extremes of temperature and the terrain is mostly uninhabited, sandy desert. In most parts of the country, vegetation is limited to weeds, xerophytic herbs and shrubs. Animals include the ibex, wildcats, baboons, wolves, and hyenas in the highlands. Small birds are found in the oases. The coastal area of the Red Sea, especially the coral reefs, have a rich marine fauna. Saudi Arabia has coastline of 4,000 kilometers.

The climate of the Kingdom varies from region to region, according to its location. Since the Kingdom lies in the tropics, the nationwide average temperature is 18C°. However, temperature varies considerably, increasing as we descend towards the southwest.

The average temperature reaches 24C° in the Western Region, 38C° in Jeddah and 30C° in Jizan. The Central Region is extremely hot and dry. Saudi Arabia has no rivers or permanent streams. Although the dry valleys are often flooded with rain water, actual utilization of this water is limited due to evaporation and soil absorption.

The Desert Regions

Saudi Arabia consists mostly of semi-desert and desert with oasis. Almost half of the total country is uninhabitable desert with annual precipitation up to 100 mm in most regions. The western regions are plateau and the east is lowland. The southwest region has mountains as high as 3000 meters, and is an area known for the greenest and freshest climate in all of the country. The capital, Riyadh, which is to the center-east, has an average temperature in July of 42C° and 14C° in January. In contrast, Jeddah on the western coast has 31C° in July and 23C° in January.

Less than 2 percent of the total area is suitable for cultivation, and in the early 1990s, population distribution varied greatly among the towns of the eastern and western coastal areas, the densely populated interior oasis, and the vast, almost empty deserts, such as the Rub' al Khali (Empty Quarter), the Arabian Desert and East Sahero-Arabian xeric shrub lands. There are no permanent rivers and lakes in Saudi Arabia.

The Coastal Regions

Along the coastal regions of the Red Sea and the Arabian Gulf, the desert temperature is moderated by the proximity of these large bodies of water. Temperatures seldom rise above 38° C, but the relative humidity is usually more than 85% and frequently 100% for extended periods. This combination produces a hot mist during the day and a warm fog at night. Prevailing winds are from the north, and, when they blow, coastal areas become bearable in summer and even pleasant in winter. A southerly wind is accompanied invariably by an increase in temperature and humidity and by a particular kind of storm known in the gulf area.

In late spring and early summer, a strong northwesterly wind, the Shamal, blows; it is particularly severe in eastern Arabia and continues for almost three months. The Shamal produces sandstorms and dust storms that can decrease visibility to a few meters.

The region of Asir is subject to Indian and Atlantic Oceans monsoons, usually occurring between October and March. An average of 300 millimeters of rainfall occurs during this period—60% of the annual total. Additionally, in Asir and the southern Hijaz condensation caused by the higher mountain slopes contributes to the total rainfall.